

6. Our solar system formed about 4.5 billion years ago.

(a) Tick (✓) the boxes next to the **two** correct statements. [2]

Our solar system originated from a cloud of gas and dust. ☐

The heavy elements in our solar system originated from a supernova. ☐

The Sun formed when large asteroids clumped together. ☐

At the end of our Sun’s life, heavy elements will be returned to space. ☐

(b) The table gives information about some planets in our solar system.

Planet	Mean distance from Sun (AU)	Diameter (1000 km)	Length of day (Earth days)	Length of year i.e. time to orbit the Sun (Earth years)
Venus	0.7	12	243	0.6
Earth	1.0	13	1	1
Mars	1.5	7	1	2
Saturn	9.5	120	0.4	29
Uranus	19.2	50	0.7	84
Neptune	30.0	50	0.7	165

Use the information in the table to answer the following questions.

(i) State which planet is closest in size to Earth. [1]

(ii) State which planet has a day length longer than its year. [1]



- (iii) Natalie says the larger the gas giant planet the longer its days are.
Rhian says Natalie is wrong.
Explain whether you agree with Natalie or Rhian.

[2]

Examiner
only

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